

VIVEK MAHARAJ

IT SPECIALIST | ESCALATIONS, SYSTEMS
ARCHITECTURE & CLIENT-FACING
TECHNOLOGY

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Accomplished IT professional with 4+ years of experience spanning L3 software escalations, SaaS platforms, network infrastructure, and applied software engineering. Proven track record of resolving high-impact technical issues, driving root cause analysis, and translating complex challenges into actionable solutions that enhance system performance and client outcomes.

Recognised for maintaining operational stability under pressure, collaborating seamlessly across development, support, and business teams, and delivering results that combine technical depth with strategic insight. Holds certifications in AWS, Cisco Networking, and Cybersecurity, and brings a unique ability to bridge technical execution with business impact.

EDUCATION

Richfield Graduate Institute of Technology

BSc Honours in Information Technology

Feb 2026 - Dec 2026

Information and Cyber Security, Research Methodology, IT Strategy and Governance, Advanced Software Engineering, Metaverse, Big Data Analytics, IT Entrepreneurship and Innovation, IT Law and Ethics

Richfield Graduate Institute of Technology

BSc in Information Technology (Cum Laude)

Feb 2023 - Dec 2025

Data Science, Networking, Python, Java, C++, Database Systems (SQL), Cloud Computing, Cybersecurity, AI, Machine Learning, Software Engineering, Operating Systems, Mobile App Development, Big Data & IoT

Kharina Secondary School

National Senior Certificate

Jan 2017 - Dec 2021

Afrikaans, English, Geography, Life Orientation, Life Sciences, Mathematics and Physical Science

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Languages & APIs: Python, Java, C++, SQL, REST APIs, Postman
- Infrastructure & Networking: LAN/WAN, Network Security, Traffic Analysis
- Cloud & SaaS: AWS (Foundations, Security), SaaS Production Environments
- Security: Vulnerability Validation, Burp Suite, Encryption Fundamentals
- Incident & Client Operations: L3 Escalations, Root Cause Analysis (RCA),

EXPERIENCE

Software Escalations Specialist (L3)

Orange Thunder Technologies t/a SimplePay

May 2025 – Present

- Delivered end-to-end support across multiple payroll jurisdictions, including South Africa, Ireland, Singapore, and Hong Kong, handling region-specific tax, statutory, and payroll calculation logic.
- Owned and resolved high-severity L3 escalations involving API failures, payroll calculation inconsistencies, data integrity issues, and system exceptions in a live SaaS production environment.
- Produced detailed Technical Reports including replication steps, log analysis, stack traces, and root cause findings, reducing developer investigation time by 30–40%.
- Acted as the technical liaison between Support, Engineering, and Product teams, ensuring accurate issue translation and faster resolution cycles.
- Conducted manual vulnerability validation and penetration testing using Burp Suite, confirming or disproving reported security findings.
- Troubleshooted and validated REST API integrations using Postman, analysing authentication flows, request payloads, response codes, and error handling.
- Identified recurring system defects and workflow inefficiencies, contributing to measurable reductions in repeat incidents and escalations.
- Supported long-term platform stability through root cause analysis and preventative recommendations.

Customer Support Specialist (L1)

Orange Thunder Technologies t/a SimplePay

Sep 2024 – Aug 2025

- Delivered front-line technical and payroll support with sustained customer satisfaction scores above 95%.
- Resolved complex payroll, compliance, and accounting-related queries across multiple client environments.
- Supported Xero and e@syFile integrations, assisting clients with accurate financial and statutory reporting.
- Converted warm leads into paying customers, including mid-sized and enterprise organisations (100+ employees), directly contributing to revenue growth.
- Identified recurring escalation patterns early, feeding insights into L3 workflows and improving platform reliability.

Campus Infrastructure Consultant

Richfield Graduate Institute of Technology

Oct 2023 – Sep 2024

- Designed, implemented, and supported a 100+ workstation LAN, including physical cabling, switch configuration, and fault resolution.
- Maintained high network availability for academic and administrative operations.
- Provided technical mentorship and guest lectures, translating complex IT concepts into accessible, practical knowledge.

Technical Reports, Enterprise Client Communication

- Supported infrastructure troubleshooting with minimal downtime during active academic periods.

CERTIFICATIONS

Amazon Web Service (AWS)

- Cloud Foundations
- Cloud Security Foundations
- Data Centre Technician
- Engineering Operations Technician
- Introduction to Blockchain
- Machine Learning Foundations

Cisco

- Introduction to Cybersecurity
- Introduction to IoT
- Networking Essentials
- Ethical Hacker

CompTIA

- A+ Cert Prep + Practice Exam
- N+ Cert Prep

Google

- Ads Search
- Analytics

Miscellaneous

- Ethical Hacking and Penetration Testing
- Harvard Introduction to Computer Science (CS50)
- Introduction to Cybersecurity
- Introduction to VMware
- Network Security
- Networking Foundations
- More can be viewed on my [LinkedIn](#)

LEADERSHIP & ACHIEVEMENTS

- SRC Vice President (Executive Governance & Leadership)
- Golden Key International Honour Society Member
- DUX Awardee
- Top Achiever Award
- [EF SET English Proficiency: C2](#)

LICENSES

- Drivers: Code 8 (B)
- Fire fighting level 1
- First aid level 1

VOLUNTEER WORK

- Sensei | Kyokushin Karate PMB
- Peer Promoter | SANBS
- Food Server | M.L Sultan Frail Care Centre
- Animal Care Associate | SPCA

Software Engineering Intern

CodeAlpha

Jul 2024 – Aug 2024

- Engineered multiple projects across AI, mobile application development, and cybersecurity.
- Applied software engineering principles to real-world problem scenarios.
- Projects documented and showcased on [LinkedIn](#) and [GitHub](#).

Technical Support Intern

GAO Tek (GAO RFID Inc.)

Mar 2024 – Jun 2024

- Provided technical support to international clients across multiple time zones, maintaining service continuity.
- Enhanced internal documentation and support workflows using AI-assisted tooling, improving response consistency.
- Contributed to training material development and internal knowledge base optimisation.

KEY PROJECTS

Portfolio Website – Personal Technical Portfolio

Jan 2024 – Present

- Designed and deployed a professional portfolio website showcasing technical projects, infrastructure knowledge, and security-focused work.
- Implemented responsive design, structured content delivery, and secure hosting practices.
- Used as a live demonstration of system ownership, technical communication, and professional branding.

Campus Cart – Cloud-Native Student Commerce Platform (Product & Systems Lead)

Aug 2025 – Dec 2025

- Designed and built a scalable, cloud-ready student commerce platform focused on security, access control, and data privacy.
- Applied SaaS design principles with future institutional deployment in mind.
- Demonstrates product leadership, systems thinking, and real-world problem solving.

Hand Gesture Recognition Application – Computer Vision (Python, OpenCV)

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

- Developed a real-time hand gesture recognition system using Python and OpenCV.
- Implemented gesture mapping to trigger predefined system actions.
- Demonstrates applied knowledge of computer vision, image processing, human-computer interaction, and event-driven automation.

Additional Technical Projects

- Voice-Controlled Virtual Assistant (Automation & Systems Interaction)
- File Encryption & Decryption System (Cryptography & Data Security)
- Network Sniffer & Traffic Analysis Tool (Packet Inspection & Network Security)
- All projects can be viewed [here](#)